ments, much like a credit card, the difference being that the amount could be paid back to the company in monthly instalments. Similar to pre-approved loans, these cards allowed customers to make quick purchases with very limited risks involved.

Following the pattern, several firms came up offering EMI offers and EMI cards to very low net worth individuals. Most companies set their criteria very liberally - 21 or above of age, have a regular income, have an address proof, have a bank account. The liberal nature of these schemes made EMI a very lucrative chance for freshers and young professionals looking to up their lifestyle or accentuate their working conditions. This was especially a good opportunity for the new age of freelancers looking to accelerate their working conditions.

The cream of the crop in this sector would be *Kissht.com*, Zest Money, and *Snapmint.com*. While *Kissht.com* provides EMI cards with a pre-approved credit limit, Zest Money and *Snapmint.com* take a different strategy into focus. They partner with online retailers to generate customer and product

Image showing Bajaj Finserv EMI Card

specific vouchers with which you can make the required purchase on the vendor site. The EMI approval is quick and mostly paperless while monthly instalment is easy to do via online banking or digital payments. A disadvantage with *Kissht.com* would be their requirement of a post-dated cheque as a guarantee. All of these sites provide no-cost EMI schemes where the interest is either provided as an upfront discount, or the interest component is refunded to the borrower after each monthly instalment. Another exceptional advantage that makes these schemes attractive is their zero foreclosure charges policy. Most EMI based NBFCs have schemes with no foreclosure conditions, unlike traditional banking partners.